

2. The **epicentre** is the point on the Earth's surface directly above an earthquake. Seismic stations detect earthquakes by the tracings made on seismographs.

(a) Surface, P and S waves are three types of earthquake waves.
Tick (✓) the boxes next to the **three** correct statements about earthquake waves. [3]

Surface waves travel the fastest ☐

S waves travel on the surface of the Earth ☐

S waves are transverse waves ☐

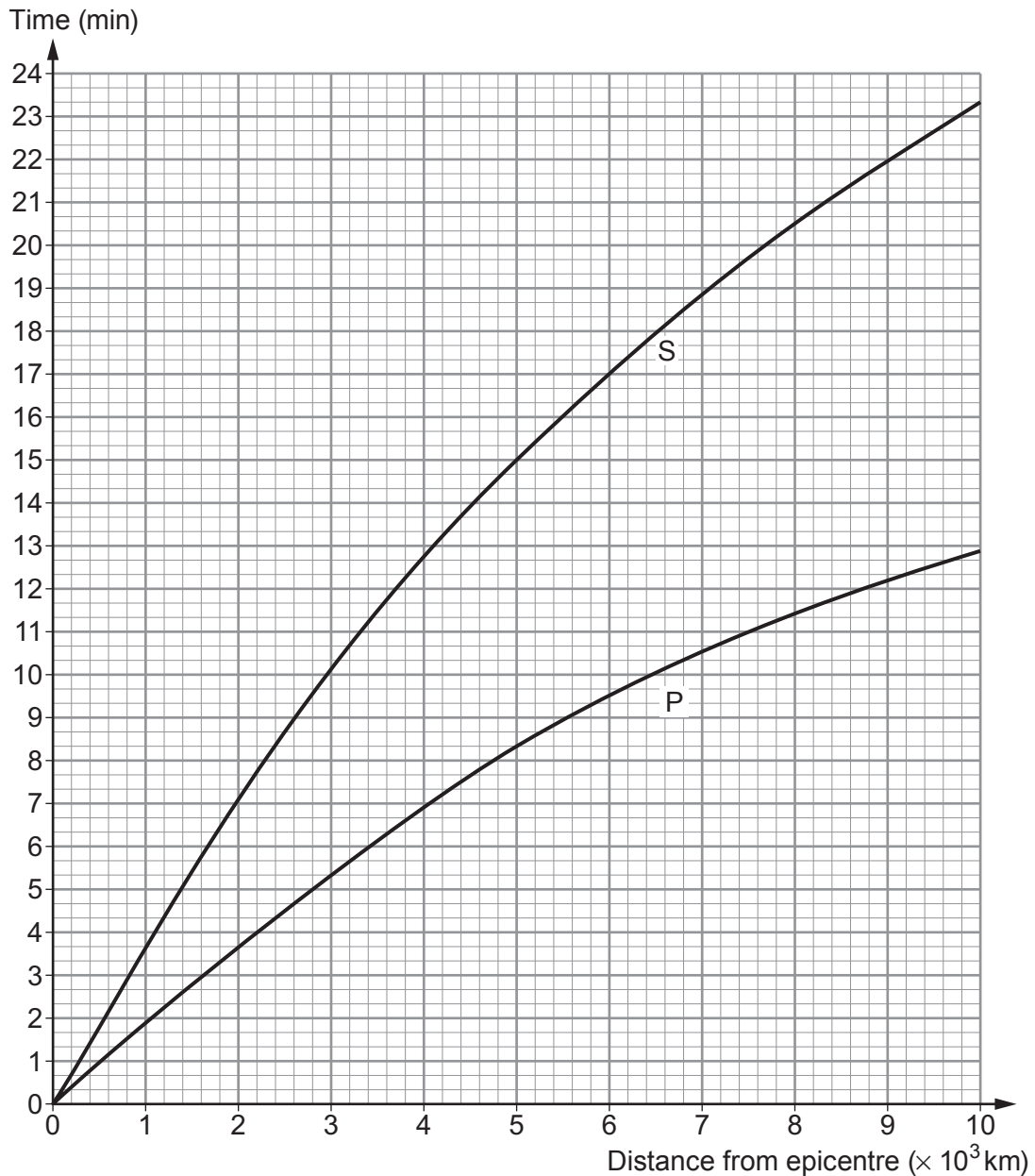
P waves travel through solids and liquids ☐

P waves are longitudinal waves ☐

S waves cause the most damage ☐



- (b) The graph shows the time taken by P and S waves to travel different distances from the epicentre.



Each small square on the time axis represents 20 s.

- (i) Use the graph to answer the following questions.

I. State the time it takes for a P wave to travel 5×10^3 km from the epicentre.

[1]

time = min s

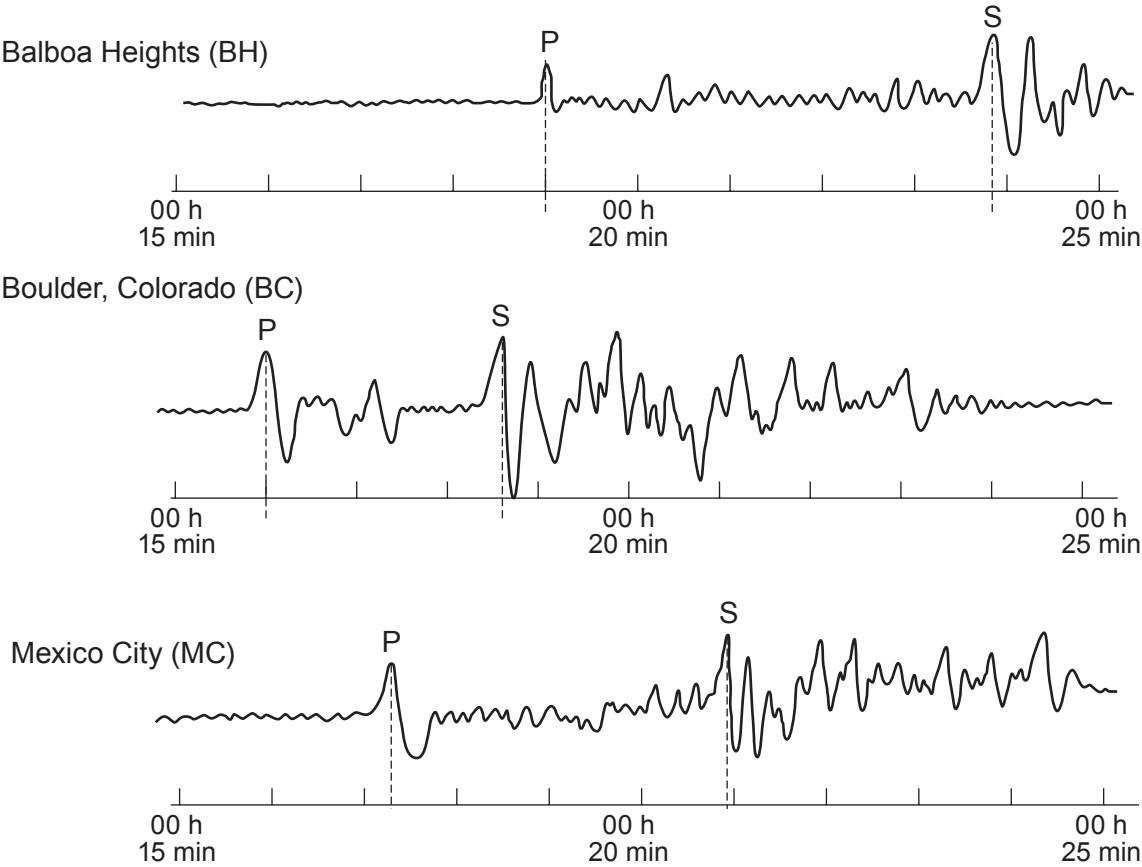
II. State the **extra** time it takes S waves to travel 5×10^3 km from the epicentre.

[1]

time = min s



(ii) Study the three seismograph tracings below. Tracings made at three separate seismic stations are needed to locate an earthquake epicentre. P shows the arrival of P waves and S shows the arrival of S waves.

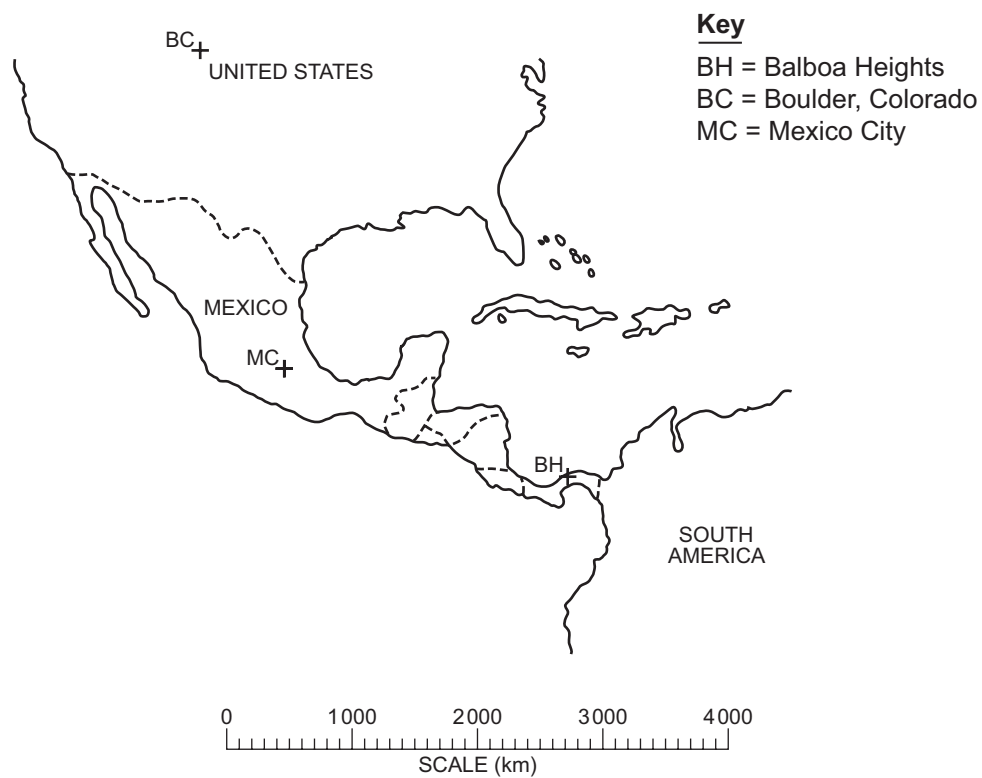


Use the information in the graph and tracings to **complete the table**. [3]

City	Arrival time of P waves (h:min:s)	Arrival time of S waves (h:min:s)	Time difference for P and S waves (h:min:s)	Distance to epicentre ($\times 10^3$ km)
Balboa Heights (BH)	00:19:00	00:23:50	00:04:50	3.2
Boulder, Colorado (BC)	 : :	00:18:40	 : :	
Mexico City (MC)	00:17:15	00:20:55	00:03:40	2.2



- (iii) Use the data in the table to find the epicentre of the earthquake on the diagram below. [3]



Examiner
only

